



Bondly

• CONFIDENTIAL — INTERNAL STRATEGY

— COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE REPORT

The SA Bond Origination **War.**

A three-round, adversarially-verified teardown of BetterBond, ooba, and the fintech challengers reshaping South Africa's R1.88-trillion mortgage market — and the three places Bondly can win.

PREPARED FOR

Bondly Strategy

DATE

18 June 2026

METHOD

3-round deep research

SOURCES

73 · 3 rounds

The market is won at the agent, not the app.

South African bond origination looks like a consumer-choice market — slick websites, calculators, "apply online in minutes." It mostly isn't. The home-buyer rarely chooses their originator; the **estate agent defaults it at offer-to-purchase**, and the incumbents have spent a decade buying the agent layer. That single structural fact reframes every recommendation in this report.

R1.88^{tn}

SA MORTGAGES
OUTSTANDING, END-2024
(SARB)

R336.7^{bn}

NEW RESIDENTIAL BONDS
GRANTED, 2024 — DOWN
FROM R391BN IN 2022

~1 in 3

SA HOME LOANS VIA
BETTERHOME GROUP (SELF-
CLAIMED)

R0

COST TO THE BUYER — THE
BANK PAYS THE COMMISSION

The five things that matter

- **It's a B2B2C referral market.** SA's own originator regulator (MORCSA) calls estate-agent referral "the primary channel" through which buyers reach originators.
- **BetterBond's moat is ownership, not UX.** Parent BetterHome owns stakes in RE/MAX, Chas Everitt, Tyson, Just Property, a majority of Private Property, and lead-gen tool amplifi.
- **The real disruptor is MortgageMarket,** not the incumbents — direct bank contracts, <2-min pre-approval, a white-label platform.
- **The market is shrinking** (~14% new residential lending vs 2022), so incumbents are defending, not expanding.
- **Pure-AI broking has failed everywhere it's been tried.** Hybrid human+AI wins.

Bondly's three openings

01 Own the switch

Incumbents optimise for *purchase* origination. The refinance/switch market — Bondly's "Stop overpaying" wedge — is barely contested and needs no estate agent.

02 Weaponise transparency

The "commission doesn't affect your rate" claim is unproven and the law already forces commission disclosure. An openly on-your-side originator attacks the trust gap.

03 Hybrid AI, not no-human

Use AI to compress turnaround and pre-qual; keep humans for the anxiety moments. The global evidence says this is the only model that converts.

"Does the buyer choose the originator at all — or does the agent choose it for them?"

The contrarian question that dictates Bondly's entire go-to-market. Answered on p.5.

What's inside.

Eleven sections, built from three rounds of fan-out web research, adversarial 3-vote fact-checking, and a Bondly-specific strategic synthesis.

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Size, mechanics, and why it's contracting

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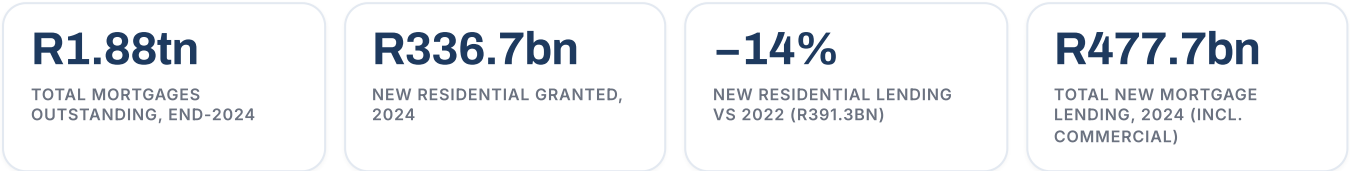
AT A GLANCE · THE FIELD

PLAYER	FOUNDED	OWNER	MODEL FOCUS	BANKS	EDGE	CONF.
BetterBond	2000	BetterHome Group	Purchase origination	8	Agency & portal ownership	● HI
ooba	1999	ARC (Motsepe) control	Purchase origination	9	First-mover, brand, data	● HI
MortgageMarket	2019	Independent · IDF Capital	Direct-deal + white-label	7	Speed + embedded rails	● HI
EasyMortgages	2025	MortgageMarket tech · EasyEquities reach	Embedded fintech	7	EasyEquities user base	● HI
SA Home Loans	1999	Independent lender	Bond switching	Self-funded	Dedicated switch product	● HI
MortgageMax	—	BetterHome Group	Purchase origination	Majors	Group's 2nd brand	● MED
Bondly	—	—	Switch / refinance	7	Savings-led, AI, transparent	● OWN

MortgageMarket is independent — founded 2019 by Tim Akinnusi, ~\$0.69m seed from IDF Capital. EasyEquities / Purple Group is a **distribution partner, not a shareholder**; EasyMortgages runs on MortgageMarket's white-label engine (which also powers MTN MoMo). SA Home Loans is both a panel lender and the one incumbent actively marketing bond switching.

A R1.88-trillion market — that's quietly shrinking.

Origination is a thin, bank-funded layer sitting on top of an enormous but currently contracting mortgage market. Understanding the denominator is the first thing round-1 research couldn't do — and round-2 fixed it with SARB data.



Source: SA Reserve Bank Quarterly Bulletin, March 2025 (series 1470M / 1474M / 1480M). Verified 3-0 / 2-0 in adversarial check.

How bond origination actually works

A bond originator is a free-to-the-consumer broker. The buyer (or, usually, their estate agent) submits **one application**; the originator packages it to each bank's spec and fires it at **multiple lenders simultaneously** — the big-five banks (Absa, FNB, Nedbank, Standard Bank, Investec) plus specialists (RMB, Sentinel Homes, HIP, SA Home Loans). The banks return competing quotes; the buyer picks one; **the winning bank pays the originator a commission**. The buyer pays nothing.

This model — verified 3-0 across both incumbents and SA's industry regulator — is the universal mechanic. Every player runs it. Differentiation therefore comes from **distribution, speed, trust and segment**, not the core mechanism.

FLOW One application → many banks

- Buyer/agent submits a single application
- Originator tailors & submits to up to 9 lenders
- Banks compete; buyer chooses the best offer
- Winning bank pays commission on the settled loan
- Buyer pays R0

Indicatively 1–1.9% of the loan — but no primary source discloses it.

Three research rounds confirm the bank-pays model (3-0) yet never the rate. The 1–1.9% band — **≈R12k–R23k on a R1.2m bond**, implying a ~R3–6bn annual origination-commission pool — appears only in secondary snapshots. Treat as indicative; early-settlement clawback terms remain undocumented.

WHY THE CONTRACTION MATTERS TO BONDLY

Incumbents are defending

A ~14% purchase market means BetterBond/ooba are fighting over a shrinking pie — capital goes to retention, not innovation.

Switching is counter-cyclical

When new purchases fall, refinancing/switching rises as owners chase rate relief. Bondly's wedge is timed with the cycle.

R1.88tn of installed base

Every existing bond is a switch candidate. The switch TAM is the whole book, not just this year's R337bn of new loans.

The contrarian question, answered.

This is the report's spine. If buyers choose originators, a better app wins. If *agents* choose for them, the war is fought a layer up — and the incumbents already own that layer.

"[Estate-agent referral is] the primary channel through which consumers are informed of their ability to use the services of bond brokers."

— MORCSA (Mortgage Originators Regulatory Council of SA), submission to the SA Parliament (pmg.org.za). Primary source.

SA's own originator regulator confirms it: this is a **B2B2C referral market**. The agent, at the offer-to-purchase moment, routes the buyer to whichever originator they default to. Referral relationships between agencies, agents, developers and bond brokers are described as **"common place in the industry."**

But — the crack — "a referral does not legally oblige a consumer to use a given originator."

The agent *defaults* the choice; they cannot *compel* it. A buyer who already knows Bondly can override the default.

Why this is a moat the incumbents bought

BetterHome Group didn't win the agent layer by persuasion — it **acquired equity** in it:

- Stakes in **RE/MAX SA** (2015), **RealNet**, **Chas Everitt**, **Tyson Properties** (2015), **Fine & Country** (2022), **Just Property** (2024)
- **Majority shareholder of Private Property** (2023) — ~3m monthly unique visitors, a captive top-of-funnel
- **amplifi** — a social-media lead-gen engine sold *to agents*, partnered with Private Property

When your parent owns the agency, the portal and the agent's lead tool, the "referral" to BetterBond is structurally pre-loaded.

Source: betterhome.co.za/our-investments (primary, self-reported); propertyprofessional.co.za on amplifi. Rate limit prevented independent triple-verification — treat agency-stake list as single-source.

STRATEGIC READ

Two doors are open — and Bondly should walk through both

Door A — go around the agent. The *switch* market has no estate agent. A homeowner refinancing an existing bond reaches Bondly direct. The incumbents' agency moat is worth nothing here.

Door B — win the agent. Where purchase origination matters, give agents a faster, higher-approval, better-tracked tool so *they* default to Bondly — competing on agent throughput, not consumer polish.

CORROBORATED THREE INDEPENDENT WAYS

MORCSA · the regulator

The originator industry body tells Parliament agent referral is "the primary channel" through which buyers reach originators — while conceding it never obliges the buyer.

The process map

Academic & portal descriptions agree: buyer signs the offer → agent asks how it's financed → forwards details to the originator → originator calls the buyer.

Industry reality · IOL

"Most agencies these days own, have JVs with, or are affiliated to" an originator — and historically earned 0.3–1.3% referral fees for the introduction.

The one number that didn't survive: a "~60% of home loans via origination" figure was refuted (1-2). The channel-split % remains unquantified — a known gap.

BetterBond & the BetterHome conglomerate.

Not a bond originator with a marketing budget — a vertically-integrated home-journey holding company that happens to originate bonds. This is the structure to respect.

BetterBond

BETTERHOME GROUP · EST. 2000

INCUMBENT · SCALE LEADER

CORE MODEL

Single application → 8-lender panel (big-5 + RMB, Sentinel, HIP)

DISTRIBUTION

Captive agency stakes + Private Property + amplifi lead-gen

DIGITAL

24/7/365 online application, doc upload, e-sign

SELF-CLAIMED SCALE

"~1 in 3" SA home loans; "1m+" homeowners served (unaudited)

REPUTATION

Hellobeter 4.79 / 5 across 2,322 reviews

SISTER BRAND

MortgageMax (group's 2nd originator)

The group is the strategy

BetterHome Group spans **origination** (BetterBond + MortgageMax), **real estate** (Private Property, amplifi, Loom, plus equity in major agencies), and **insurance** (BetterSure). Each home-buyer touchpoint feeds the next: a Private Property listing → an agent who uses amplifi → a referral to BetterBond → a BetterSure policy.

This is the moat. A standalone originator competes on one transaction; BetterHome monetises the **whole home journey** and controls the lead before a competitor sees it.

Two of the group's two origination brands — BetterBond and MortgageMax — together are credited with ~30% of the SA mortgage market.

Self-reported group figure; the specific "25% / BetterBond alone" and "largest originator" claims were refuted 0-3 in verification.

WHERE IT'S EXPOSED

- **Purchase-only mindset.** The entire funnel assumes a buying transaction with an agent — switching is an afterthought.
- **Conglomerate inertia.** Three divisions, group politics; slow to ship a focused, modern switch product.
- **Channel conflict.** Owning agencies can deter *rival* agencies from referring to BetterBond.
- **Unverifiable superlatives.** "Largest", "1 in 3" are marketing, not audited — a credibility lever for a transparent challenger.

BetterHome's home-journey stack

Origination — BetterBond, MortgageMax · Real estate — Private Property, amplifi, Loom, REDi · Insurance — BetterSure · Agency equity — RE/MAX, Chas Everitt, Tyson, Fine & Country, Just Property, RealNet

ooba Home Loans — the pioneer.

First to bring origination to SA, strongest brand-in-category, and — confirmed this round — under the control of one of the country's most powerful capital houses.

ooba Home Loans

FORMERLY MORTGAGESA · EST. 1999

INCUMBENT · CATEGORY PIONEER

CORE MODEL "One application, up to 8 quotes" — submits to up to 9 lenders	OWNERSHIP African Rainbow Capital (Motsepe) — controlling stake since 2016
HERITAGE Brought bond origination to SA in 1999 (as MortgageSA)	BANK PANEL Absa, FNB, Nedbank, Standard Bank, Investec (+ HIP, RMB, Sentinel)
DIGITAL my.ooba.co.za portal; upload, e-sign, pre-approval w/o a property	DATA ASSET ooba Property Index / "Oobarometer" — earned-media engine

Ownership: the record, corrected

Round-1 could not confirm ooba's owner and the ARC/Motsepe link was flagged "uncertain." Round-2 found the primary record: the **SA Competition Tribunal approved African Rainbow Capital's acquisition of ooba on 12 August 2016**, with ARC taking the shareholding that lets it "hold the majority shares... and exercise veto rights." ARC is the financial-services vehicle associated with **Patrice Motsepe's** Ubuntu-Botho group.

But the nuance round-3 surfaced cuts the other way: to ARC, ooba is **tiny**. ARC's filings disclose only an **R11m dividend** from ooba (H2-2024), folded into an "Other Banking & Digital" line worth ~1.1% of a ~R19bn fund. The firepower exists — but ARC is unlikely to bankroll a price war to defend a rounding-error holding. **That's good news for Bondly**: compete on segment and speed; a sustained attrition war is improbable.

Sources: [saflii.org ZACT/2016/84](#) (Competition Tribunal — verified 3-0); *ARC Investments interim results, R11m ooba dividend & ~1.1% bundle* (verified 3-0 via filing extraction). The "Motsepe family trusts ultimately control ARC" chain was only single-sourced.

WHERE IT'S EXPOSED

- **Consultant-led core.** The model still leans on human consultants — slower, costlier per deal than an AI-first flow.
- **Purchase-centric.** Like BetterBond, switching is a side resource, not the product.
- **"Leading originator" is unproven.** Refuted 0-3; ooba's own superlatives don't survive scrutiny.
- **Brand = incumbency.** Pioneer status reads as "established" to some, "legacy" to a younger, rate-shopping switcher.

ooba's Property Index is its sharpest weapon — and Bondly's cheapest one to copy.

A quarterly, data-driven index earns press, backlinks and authority at near-zero cost. A "Bondly Switch Index" could do the same for the refinance narrative.

MortgageMarket & EasyMortgages.

Beating ooba and BetterBond is the wrong frame. The right reference class is the fintech that is quietly rebuilding the rails — and it looks a lot like what Bondly wants to be.

MortgageMarket

EST. 2019 · FOUNDER TIM AKINNUSI · IDF CAPITAL-BACKED

FINTECH · RAILS-BUILDER

BREAKTHROUGH

Claims first co. in 25 yrs with **direct origination contracts at all major banks** (FNB, Absa, Std Bank, Nedbank, RMB, Investec)

PLATFORM PLAY

White-label rails powering EasyMortgages, Takealot, VodaLend, MTN MoMo, Telkom Financial Services

SPEED CLAIM

Pre-approval in **<2 minutes**; grants in **<48 hours**

DISTRIBUTION

Embedded finance — origination inside other companies' apps

EasyMortgages: the embedded model

Announced May 2025, **EasyMortgages** puts a fully-digital home loan *inside the EasyEquities app*, letting its large retail-investor base compare offers from the major banks and pre-approve "in minutes." The technology is MortgageMarket's; EasyEquities supplies the audience — a partnership, not an acquisition (Purple Group holds no equity). This is **distribution by embedding**, not by estate agent — the one model that genuinely routes around the incumbents' moat.

WHY BONDLY MUST WATCH THIS

- It validates the **AI-fast, low-human** origination thesis in SA — and got the bank deals to back it.
- Embedded distribution (Takealot, MTN MoMo) is a **scalable answer to the agent moat**.
- If it adds **switching**, it competes directly with Bondly's wedge. Speed-to-market matters.

VERIFIED 3-0

What's actually confirmed

- One application → SA's top 7 banks; offers back in **~72 hours**
- Same white-label engine powers **MTN MoMo & VTC Africa**
- EasyMortgages is a partnership — **Purple/EasyEquities holds no equity**

COMPANY-CLAIMED

Treat with caution

- "First in 25 years" with direct all-bank contracts — marketing line
- "Real-time API decisioning" — asserted, not independently audited
- Verified core is fast panel submission, not proven instant decisioning

Sources: blogs.easyequities.co.za & mortgagemarket.co.za (primary), ventureburn.com, techfinancials.co.za, disrupt-africa.com (2021 seed). Structural facts verified 3-0 in round-3; "real-time / first-in-25-years" remains company-stated.

Everyone else competing for the same bond.

Beyond the big two and the fintech, four more categories of competitor matter — each with a different angle of attack on the same registered bond.

PLAYER / CATEGORY	WHAT THEY ARE	THREAT TO BONDLY	CONFIDENCE
MortgageMax	BetterHome Group's second origination brand — a multi-brand strategy to capture different agency relationships	Extends the group's agent lock-in; same moat, two front doors	● MED
Banks' direct channels	Absa/FNB/Nedbank/Standard Bank own apps & branches — origination at zero commission to the bank	Structural: if banks push direct, they squeeze every originator's economics, Bondly included	● MED
Roost · MultiNET	Additional independent originators running the same multi-bank panel model	Fragment the long tail of agent relationships; minor individually	● LOW
Comparison portals (Hippo & sim.)	Insurance-led aggregators extending into home-loan lead capture	Compete for the same "compare & save" search intent Bondly targets	● LOW
SA Home Loans	Non-bank lender that actively markets bond switching ("Switch smart") — dedicated calculators, consultants, capitalise-fees option	The direct rival in Bondly's switch wedge — the one player already there	● HI
Switch specialists	Investec "Switching Home Loans", Debt2Bond Bond Switch, bondoriginators.co.za — niche rate-switch players	Validate the switch category — and begin to crowd it	● LOW

READ

The bank direct-channel is the quiet existential risk

Originators exist because banks find them cheaper than branch acquisition. If a bank decides its app converts better at zero commission, it can dial down originator volume overnight. This risk is **shared by every originator** — but it's also why **banks value a channel that brings them switchers they'd otherwise never see**. Bondly's switch focus makes it *additive* to banks, not just another purchase-lead reseller.

OPPORTUNITY

Be the channel banks *want*

A switcher leaving Bank A for Bank B is **net-new business** for Bank B — exactly the customer a bank will pay commission to win. Positioning Bondly as the originator that delivers **incremental, rate-motivated switchers** (not cannibalised purchase leads) is a stronger commercial pitch to banks than the incumbents can make.

First-mover, then integrate, then lock the channel.

The incumbents' dominance isn't a product story — it's a 25-year distribution story. The same playbook, in three moves.

1999 — Create the category

MortgageSA (later ooba) invents SA bond origination, persuading banks that a free-to-buyer broker is cheaper than branch acquisition. First-mover brand advantage compounds for two decades.

2000 — Fast follower at scale

BetterBond launches and races ooba for the same agent relationships, turning a two-horse category into a national footprint of consultants.

2015–2017 — Buy the agents

BetterHome takes equity stakes in RE/MAX, Chas Everitt, Tyson, RealNet — converting referral goodwill into ownership. ARC takes control of ooba (2016), adding capital firepower.

2022–2024 — Own the funnel

BetterHome takes majority of Private Property (2023), adds Fine & Country (2022), Just Property (2024), and launches amplifi to feed agents leads. The channel is now vertically owned.

2025–2026 — Fintech arrives

MortgageMarket secures direct bank contracts and embeds origination in EasyEquities, Takealot & telco apps — the first credible *distribution* innovation in 25 years.

The three repeatable moves

- **1 · First-mover brand** — own the category word ("bond originator") and the data narrative (Property Index).
- **2 · Vertical integration** — capture adjacent home-journey steps (portal, agency, insurance) so the lead never leaves the group.
- **3 · Channel ownership** — buy or lock the estate-agent layer where the default referral happens.

Bondly cannot out-incumbent the incumbents on this path — it's 25 years and a balance sheet behind.

The winning move is to change the game (switch + embed + transparency), not replay it.

The new playbook MortgageMarket revealed

Distribution by **embedding** (in apps people already use) + **direct bank rails** for speed. This is leapfrog, not catch-up — and it's available to Bondly too.

Content for credibility, channel for conversion.

The incumbents win two ways: a deep SEO/content layer that earns trust and search traffic, and a captive referral channel that converts. Bondly must out-execute the first and route around the second.

What the incumbents do

- **Resource-hub SEO.** ooba and BetterBond run vast libraries of calculators, guides and FAQs ("how do originators make money", affordability, pre-approval) that capture high-intent search and build authority.
- **Data-as-PR.** ooba's quarterly Property Index / Oobarmeter earns national press and backlinks — authority at near-zero marginal cost.
- **Captive lead-gen.** Private Property (~3m monthly visitors) + amplifi feed agents, who feed BetterBond. The cheapest lead is one you already own.
- **Trust signals.** Hellopeter 4.79/5 (2,322 reviews) is displayed as social proof and defends against challenger doubt.

HOW BONDLY OUT-MARKETS THEM

- **Own "switch" search.** Incumbents under-serve refinance intent ("lower my home-loan rate", "switch bond"). Build the definitive switch content hub.
- **Launch a Switch Index.** A quarterly data story on how much SA homeowners overpay — the ooba-Index playbook, aimed at refinancing.
- **Savings-led hook.** Bondly's "Stop overpaying" calculator *quantifies the prize* before asking for anything — a sharper conversion mechanic than "apply now".
- **Embed, don't beg.** Follow MortgageMarket: partner into apps/banks/employers where switchers already are.

Reviews are a feature spec, not a vanity metric.

Mine incumbents' 1-2★ reviews for the recurring failure themes (turnaround, consultant silence, wrong-bank submission) and make the opposite Bondly's product promise.

⚠ Evidence note on this section

Specific SEO rankings, paid-media spend and exclusive-vs-non-exclusive agency contract terms were **not individually verified** — the round-2 verifier hit a session rate limit before completing. The strategic direction is well-grounded (the captive-channel structure is primary-sourced); the granular acquisition metrics are a recommended **next research sprint** (Google Ads Transparency Center + live SERP scrape + agency-contract digging).

The most important slide for Bondly's roadmap.

Bondly's core bet is "AI automation beats the consultant model." The global evidence says: half-right. Automate the workflow, not the human out of the anxiety moment.

The digital baseline (table stakes)

Both incumbents already offer 24/7 online application, in-app document upload and e-signature. **Digitisation is not a differentiator** — it's the entry ticket. MortgageMarket raised the bar to **<2-min pre-approval and <48-hr grants** on proprietary, bank-direct rails. Bondly must at minimum match this speed.

The AI-automation reality, from abroad

- **Habito (UK)** — pure-digital broker; CEO departed amid a hard pivot. Fully-automated broking struggled to convert.
- **Better.com (US)** — aggressive no-human model; post-SPAC stock collapse; now publicly frames its AI as **"empowering loan officers, not replacing them."**
- **Trussle (UK)** — Goldman-backed digital broker, absorbed by Better (~\$9m, 2021) — independence didn't hold.
- **J.D. Power 2025 (US)** — borrower satisfaction with lenders giving "useful guidance/advice" rose to **79% (from 69% in 2022)**. Buyers want *more* human guidance, not less.

THE SYNTHESIS

Hybrid is the only model that converts

A mortgage is a high-anxiety, once-a-decade, six-figure decision. Every market that tried to remove the human *re-added* one. The winning architecture:

- **AI does the grind** — affordability pre-qual, document OCR, bank-matching, status chasing, turnaround compression.
- **Humans do the trust** — the reassurance call at decline, the negotiation, the "is this the right call?" moment.
- **Bondly's edge:** AI makes one human as productive as five, hitting incumbent reassurance *at fintech cost*.

Don't market "no humans". Market "instant answers, real people when it counts."

The data says the consultant is a conversion asset, not just a cost — use AI to scale it, not delete it.

Sources: sifted.eu (Habito), fortune.com & housingwire.com (Better.com), cnbc.com (Trussle), scotsmanguide.com (J.D. Power). Company/press-stated; round-2 verifier rate-limited before triple-vote — directionally strong, individually unconfirmed.

The attack surface.

Where the incumbents are soft, and where South African law hands Bondly a transparency weapon the incumbents would rather you didn't notice.

INCUMBENT WEAKNESSES

- **Unverifiable superlatives.** "25% of bonds", "largest", "leading" all failed adversarial verification (0-3). A challenger that only states what it can prove looks more honest.
- **The rate-claim trust gap.** "Commission doesn't affect your interest rate" was refuted 0-3 — contested and unproven. It implies a possible incentive to steer to the highest-commission bank.
- **Purchase-only DNA.** Switching is an afterthought across the field — an open flank.
- **The 1★ pattern, named.** ooba's leading negative theme is *consultant ghosting / post-submission silence* — buyers go dark for weeks after documents are in (one verified case ran ~6.5 weeks unanswered). That is the exact failure an AI status-engine eliminates.

REGULATORY PERIMETER

- **NCA s163(3).** Originators are regulated under the National Credit Act 34 of 2005 — which already covers **disclosure of fees/commission earned**.
- **FSCA market conduct.** Subject to the Financial Sector Regulation Act 2017 (eff. 1 Apr 2018) — not regulated as estate agents.
- **FAIS "advice".** An automated affordability assessment or bank recommendation may constitute regulated *advice*, triggering suitability + record-keeping duties. Design the AI flow accordingly.
- **POPIA s71.** Constrains **automated decision-making** with legal/material effect — a real design constraint on AI-only declines.

The law already requires commission disclosure. Bondly can simply *lead* with it.

"We show you exactly what each bank pays us — and we still recommend the best rate for you." Turns a compliance line into the brand's spine.

Compliance is also a moat-in-reverse: FAIS-advice and POPIA-automated-decision rules raise the cost of doing AI origination *correctly*. Building compliant-by-design AI is a barrier later entrants must also clear — make it a strength, not an afterthought.

4.93 · #1

Ooba Hellopeter (TrustIndex 10, NPS 93)

4.93 · #3

BetterBond Hellopeter (TrustIndex 9.2)

0

NFO / FAIS / NCR Rulings vs an SA Originator found in 3 rounds

Caveat: Hellopeter is solicitation-driven and skews positive (ooba ~1.1% one-star), so complaint themes are drawn from a small negative base — directional, not a defect rate. Reputation is a real incumbent asset to displace, not dismiss.

Win the switch. Route the agent. Lead with the truth.

Five moves, ordered by leverage. Each plays where the incumbents are structurally weak, not where they are strong.

01 Own the switch market

It needs no estate agent, so the incumbents' moat is void. The TAM is the entire R1.88tn book, and it's counter-cyclical to the -14% purchase slump. Make "Stop overpaying" the category-defining switch brand before MortgageMarket pivots there.

02 Lead with radical transparency

Disclose commission openly (the NCA already requires it) and pledge best-rate, not best-commission. Directly attacks the incumbents' unproven "doesn't affect your rate" claim and the trust gap underneath it.

03 Hybrid AI, compliant by design

AI for instant pre-qual, OCR, bank-matching and turnaround; humans for the anxiety moments. Build FAIS/POPIA-aware automation now — speed of a fintech, reassurance of an incumbent, at a fraction of the cost-per-deal.

04 Distribute by embedding

Copy MortgageMarket's leapfrog: embed Bondly's switch flow into banks (as net-new switcher supply), employers, insurers and fintech apps. Routes around the agent channel entirely.

05 If you must do purchase origination — win the agent, not the buyer

Where you compete for new-purchase bonds, the customer is the agent. Give them instant pre-qual at the viewing, faster turnaround that closes their sale, and clean tracking — so **they** default to Bondly. Don't out-pretty the incumbents' consumer app; out-perform on the agent's throughput. **But sequence it second** — the switch market is the beachhead.

TWO REALITIES TO EXECUTE AGAINST

⚠ The switch lane isn't empty

SA Home Loans already markets bond-switching with calculators and consultants — and ooba reframes "refinance" as equity-release, not rate-switching. The big two have left the lane open; SAHL hasn't. Bondly must **out-execute SAHL** on AI speed, savings clarity and UX — not merely claim an empty space.

Kill the switch friction in-product

The barrier is transfer + bond-registration cost. Solve it: **capitalise the costs into the new bond** (as SAHL does), surface **Capitec's 50%-off registration** and **FNB paying cancellation/registration**, and net it against savings — so the "should I switch?" maths is already done for the user.

How this was built — and what to trust.

Three rounds of automated fan-out web research with adversarial 3-vote fact-checking, a human-directed blind-spot critique between rounds, and a final strategic synthesis. Confidence is labelled, not assumed.

321

AGENT RUNS ACROSS THREE ROUNDS

73

SOURCES FETCHED & LOGGED

39

CLAIMS THAT SURVIVED 3-VOTE VERIFICATION

The five-phase method

- **Round 1 — folklore.** 5-angle fan-out established the model, structure, history & field. Confirmed mechanics; refuted 6 incumbent superlatives.
- **Blind-spot critique.** A skeptic agent red-teamed round 1 and produced 20 sharper questions — including "who actually chooses the originator?"
- **Round 2 — hard facts.** Filings, SARB & regulators. Landed market-size & ownership before a provider rate limit cut verification short.
- **Round 3 — gap-closing.** Re-run after the limit reset: commission model, ooba's true scale, MortgageMarket's structure, complaint patterns & the switch market — fully verified.
- **Synthesis.** This document — incumbent intel fused with Bondly's product reality into a playbook.

⚠ Honest confidence caveats

- **Verified (trust as fact):** SARB market size; ooba's ARC ownership & immaterial R11m dividend; the free-to-buyer model; the agent-referral channel (3 ways); MortgageMarket's 2019/Akinnusi/IDF structure; the switch-category map; ooba's complaint pattern.
- **Company-claimed / single-source (use with care):** BetterHome's agency-stake list, MortgageMarket's "real-time / first-in-25-years", BetterBond's 160/330 headcount, the international AI press.
- **Still unknown:** the exact Rand/% commission rate & clawback terms (only an indicative 1–1.9%), audited per-originator volumes & true share, the switch market's Rand size, any ombud/NCR ruling.

REFUTED IN VERIFICATION — DO NOT CITE AS FACT

✗ "BetterBond = 25% of all new bonds" (0-3) · ✗ "BetterBond is the largest originator" (0-3) · ✗ "ooba is SA's leading originator" (0-3) · ✗ "ooba served ~600,000 families" (1-2) · ✗ "commission does not affect the consumer's interest rate" (0-3)

SELECTED SOURCES (PRIMARY & VERIFIED FIRST)

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